

System Map & Bench Reference

Every module, every interconnect, and the complete I/O map for the HVAC Pi. Pin assignments here are read from source, not from documentation — `hvac_backend.py`, `idrive_controller.ino`, and `pwm_controller.ino`.

4 active modules

1 planned link

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01 System map

Link colour is the transport, which is also what you probe it with — a scope on CAN, a terminal on serial, nothing at all on the radio link.

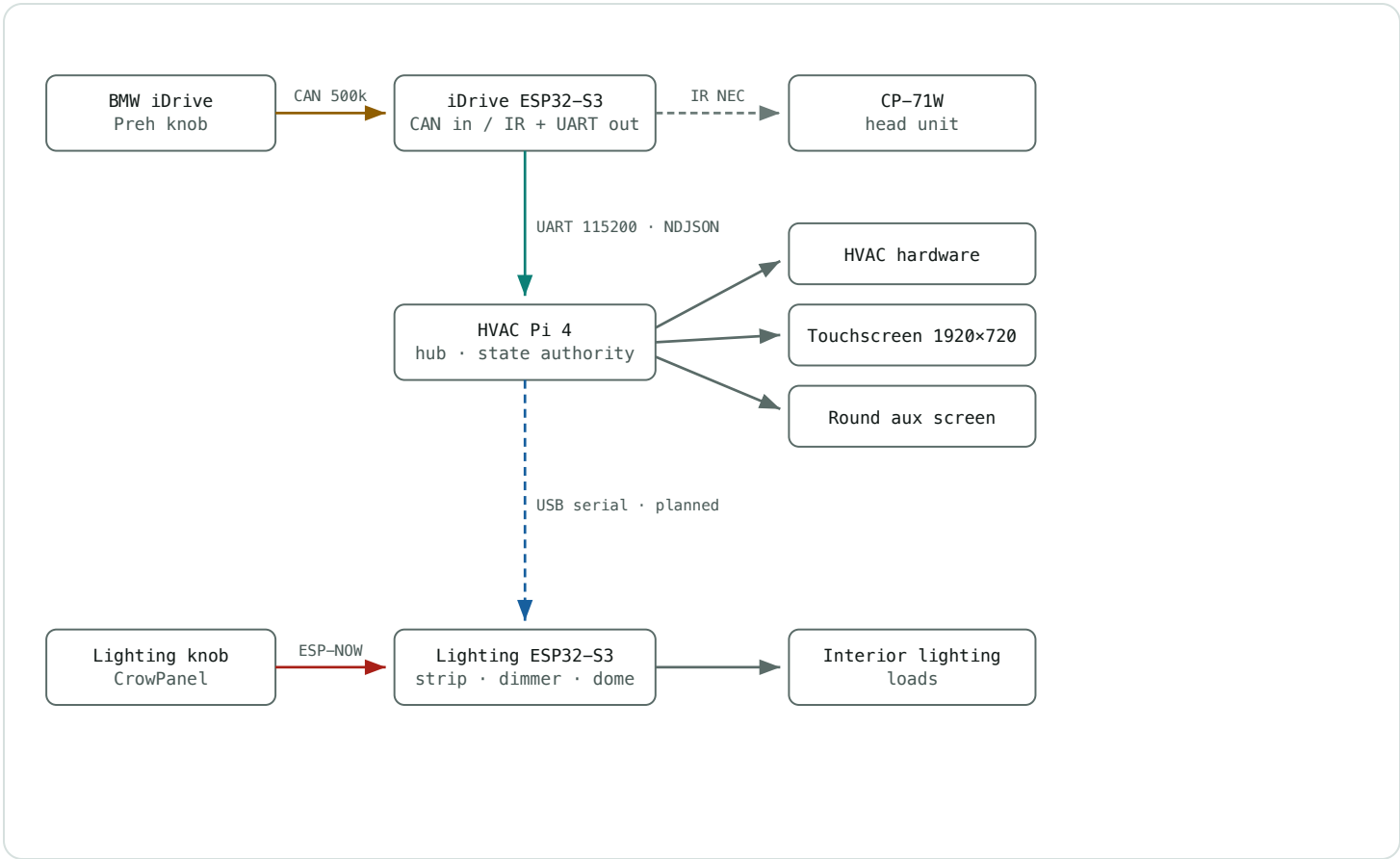
CAN 500 kbps

UART 115200

USB serial

ESP-NOW

IR 38 kHz



Not in this bench setup. The two T-Display-S3-Long aux gauge panels and the ACC/IGN ignition display are separate projects with no link to this system yet. The iDrive's GAUGE mode is reserved for the gauge panels but currently emits actions nothing consumes.

02 Module inventory

HVAC Pi 4

Hub · climate control · state authority

Host 944HVACPi · user mark
Path /home/mark/hvac/
Net eth0 192.168.1.142
Runtime Python 3.11 · FastAPI · 10 Hz loop
Serves :8000 dashboard + /ws
Repo pelosim/944_HVAC

iDrive Controller

Input surface · IR transmitter

Board Lonely Binary ESP32-S3 N16R8
MAC D0:CF:13:24:DB:B8
Core esp32 3.3.10 (~/.arduino-cli-esp32v3)
Flash tools/flash-via-pi.sh
Version v1.6.0
Repo pelosim/idrive-controller

Lighting Output

Strip · dimmer · dome relay

Board Lonely Binary ESP32-S3 N16R8
MAC 3C:DC:75:40:0B:F0
Core esp32 2.0.14 (~/.arduino-cli-esp32v2)
Partition Huge APP (3 MB, no OTA)
Repo pelosim/Automotive-Lighting-Controller

Lighting Knob

Rotary UI · ESP-NOW only

Board ELECROW CrowPanel 1.28" round
MCU ESP32-S3R8 · 240x240 GC9A01
Encoder CLK 45 · DT 42 · BTN 41
LCD power GPIO 1 + 2 HIGH before tft.begin()
Stack LVGL 9.x · TFT_eSPI

03 Interconnects

LINK	TRANSPORT	PHYSICAL	CARRIES	STATUS
iDrive knob → ESP32	CAN 500k	Green=CANH, Green/0rg=CANL SN65HVD230 · 120Ω term	ID 0x25B, all 14 inputs	Working
ESP32 → head unit	IR NEC	GPI017 → 220Ω → LED	5 codes, addr 0x00	Loopback 15/15
ESP32 → Pi	UART	ESP 43→Pi 15 · ESP 44←Pi 14 common GND	NDJSON actions	Working
ESP32 ↔ Pi	USB	/dev/idrive → ttyACM0	console + remote flashing	Working
Pi → lighting board	USB	/dev/lighting	L SET / L ADJ / L GET	Firmware ready, not wired
Knob ↔ lighting board	ESP-NOW	no wires, shared GND	4-byte packets	Working

Why the iDrive keeps both links. UART carries the data because `/dev/serial0` is stable and survives resets on either end. USB carries power and flashing because `ttyACM` re-enumerates every time the ESP reboots. Moving data onto USB would mean writing reconnect logic for no gain.

04 HVAC Pi – GPIO map

BCM numbering. Relays and solenoids are **active-LOW** — the pin is driven low to energise, so a floating or un-initialised pin leaves them off.

BCM	FUNCTION	DIRECTION	ACTIVE	DRIVES
4	DS18B20 1-Wire bus	bidir	1-Wire	3× temp sensors
5	Blower HI	out	LOW = on	relay

BCM	FUNCTION	DIRECTION	ACTIVE	DRIVES
6	Blower LOW	out	LOW = on	relay
12	Footwell flap IN1	out	HIGH	H-bridge
13	Seat heat — driver	out PWM	2 Hz	MOSFET
14	UART TXD → iDrive RX	out	serial	ESP GPIO44
15	UART RXD ← iDrive TX	in	serial	ESP GPIO43
16	Defrost flap IN1	out	HIGH	H-bridge
18	A/C clutch → MS3	out	LOW = on	relay RLY1
19	Heat valve solenoid	out	LOW = on	relay RLY2
20	Defrost flap IN2	out	HIGH	H-bridge
21	Footwell flap IN2	out	HIGH	H-bridge
23	Blend flap → COLD	out	HIGH	H-bridge
24	Blend flap → HOT	out	HIGH	H-bridge
25	Seat heat — passenger	out PWM	2 Hz	MOSFET
26	Fresh-air solenoid	out	LOW = on	relay RLY3
2 / 3	I ² C SDA / SCL	bidir	I ² C	ADS1115 @ 0x48

ANALOG FEEDBACK – ADS1115 @ 0X48

CH	MEASURES	0%	100%	WATCHDOG
A0	Blend flap position	225 mV	4090 mV	cut after 8.0 s <1.5% travel
A1	Defrost flap position	225 mV	4090 mV	as above
A2	Footwell flap position	225 mV	4090 mV	as above
A3	spare	—	—	—

TEMPERATURE – DS18B20 ON GPIO 4

SENSOR	ROM ID	RANGE SHOWN
Mixing chamber (duct)	000000bd3d51	32–180 °F
Exterior	000000be5d11	–20–120 °F
Interior / cabin	000000bbdd26	20–140 °F

IDs carry no 28– prefix. The w1thermsensor library strips it. Adding it back gives three sensors that all read zero and a dashboard that looks alive but is lying.

SERIAL PORTS

DEVICE	RESOLVES TO	PEER	BAUD	NOTES
/dev/serial0	ttyAMA0	iDrive UART	115200	needs dtoverlay=disable-bt
/dev/idrive	ttyACM0	iDrive USB	–	udev by MAC D0:CF:13:24:DB:B8
/dev/lighting	pending	Lighting board	115200	udev line commented until confirmed

Two boot-config settings are load-bearing. dtoverlay=disable-bt moves /dev/serial0 onto the real PL011. Without it you get the mini-UART, whose baud tracks the VPU core clock and corrupts under load — which the 10 Hz control loop guarantees.

And console=serial0,115200 must stay *out* of cmdline.txt, or the kernel console fights the backend for the same port. Backups sit beside both files as .bak.

BOARD	GPIO	FUNCTION	NOTES
iDrive Controller	4	CAN TX (CTX)	SN65HVD230 – never MCP2551
	8	CAN RX (CRX)	120Ω across CANH/CANL
	17	IR LED	220Ω series
	18	IR receiver	bench loopback only
	43 / 44	UART to Pi	TX / RX
	48	NeoPixel	mode colour feedback
Lighting Output	4	Illumination sense	INPUT_PULLUP, LOW = night
	5	NeoPixel data (CH1)	330Ω · 4× Flora V2
	6	MOSFET PWM (CH2)	IRLZ44N · 5 kHz · 8-bit
	7	Dome relay	active HIGH

GPIO 5, 6, 7, 15, 16 on the iDrive board are free. They hold the unused SWC resistor ladder (OUT_SWC 0), kept as a fallback in case the radio's fixed ladder is ever worth chasing.

IDRIVE → PI · NEWLINE-DELIMITED JSON

```

{"mode":"HVAC","action":"TEMP_UP","count":2}
mode    RADIO | HVAC | ILLUM | GAUGE
action  TEMP_UP TEMP_DOWN FAN_UP FAN_DOWN HVAC_TOGGLE
        HVAC_MODE_NEXT HVAC_MODE_PREV AUX_SWAP
        LIGHT_BRIGHTER LIGHT_DIMMER LIGHT_TOGGLE
        LIGHT_SCENE_NEXT LIGHT_SCENE_PREV MODE_ENTER
        VOL_UP VOL_DOWN MUTE NEXT PREV    (mirror only – IR does the work)
count   detents in this frame, clamped 1..12

```

PI ↔ LIGHTING BOARD · TEXT OUT, JSON BACK

```

L SET <ch> <val>      absolute
L ADJ <ch> <delta>    relative – what the Pi actually sends
L GET                request a state report

```

```

ch  1 = strip brightness    2 = MOSFET dimmer
     3 = dome relay         5 = palette index 0–9

```

```

{"src":"illum","ch1":200,"ch2":128,"color":3,"relay":1,"night":0}

```

LIGHTING KNOB ↔ OUTPUT BOARD · ESP-NOW, 4 BYTES

```

[ header ][ channel ][ value ][ channel XOR value ]

```

```

0xAA knob → output    0x01 ch1 · 0x02 ch2 · 0x03 relay · 0x05 colour
0xBB output → knob    0x04 day/night

```

Lighting commands are relative, never absolute. The Pi cannot know current brightness — the round knob may change it at any moment — so it sends L ADJ 1 +24 and the output board decides what that means, then reports the truth back. The board was already the owner of those values; this keeps it that way, and is the only thing stopping the two controllers from drifting apart.

07 Bench bring-up

Ordered so each step depends only on ones already passed. If a step fails, stop — later results will be misleading.

1 Power the Pi alone

No ESP boards, no loads. Confirm the backend comes up and the dashboard serves.

`systemctl is-active hvac-backend → active · http://944hvacpi.local:8000 renders`

2 Verify sensors before any actuator

All three DS18B20s should read plausible room temperature, and the ADS1115 should answer.

`/api/state → onewire_ok true, ads_ok true, three distinct temps`

3 Flap travel, one at a time

Drive each flap end to end and watch its feedback percentage track. The 8-second no-progress watchdog should cut the motor if a flap is disconnected.

`position sweeps 0→100 · disconnected flap sets *_fault true and stops`

4 Relays and solenoids

Blower HI/LOW, A/C clutch, heat valve, fresh-air. All active-LOW — listen for the click.

`each energises on command, none energised at rest`

5 Seat heaters

2 Hz PWM to the MOSFETs. Check duty at LOW/MED/HIGH (33/66/100%).

`visible slow pulsing, no buzz from the MOSFET board`

6 iDrive on CAN, bench-powered

120Ω termination fitted, grounds common. It needs one physical button press to wake on the bench.

`serial shows PRESS lines for all 14 inputs`

7

iDrive UART into the Pi

Turn the knob in HVAC mode and watch the setpoint follow on screen.

idrive_last_s non-zero · clockwise raises setpoint

8

IR at the head unit

Aim the LED at the CP-71W's IR window from close range first.

volume moves · if it works close but not from the dash, that is drive current – put the LED behind a 2N3904, do not touch the firmware

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Lighting board on USB

Flash it with the core 2.0.14 toolchain, plug into the Pi, capture its USB serial, then enable the udev line.

/dev/lighting appears · backend logs "lighting link up"

08 Known traps

Each of these cost real debugging time. They share a shape: the symptom points somewhere other than the cause.

SYMPTOM	ACTUAL CAUSE
LED lags, drops encoder events, looks like flaky hardware — then works perfectly the moment a terminal is opened	USB CDC blocks on write with no host draining it, up to ~2 s per printf. Fix is <code>Serial.setTxTimeoutMs(0)</code> . Present on both ESP32 boards.
Encoder dies after ~20 s of turning, buttons keep working	Byte 2 of 0x25B is not a two-state flag — it latches at 0x81 during sustained rotation. Never gate rotation on it.
Setpoint numerals shove the layout as the value changes	Orbitron has no tabular figures — "1" is 0.391 em against 0.834 em for "0". <code>tabular-nums</code> is silently ignored; fixed cells are the fix.
Serial link works, then reports "multiple access on port"	<code>console=serial0</code> left in <code>cmdline.txt</code> — the kernel console holds the same port.
Flashing an ESP over the Pi works sometimes, fails others	ModemManager probes new <code>ttyACM</code> devices with AT commands. udev rule ignores VID 303a.

SYMPTOM	ACTUAL CAUSE
Dashboard "still looks old" after a rebuild	Browser cache. Hard-refresh, or restart the kiosk.

09 **Harness mapping – factory sheet 5**

Read from *Wiring Diagram Type 944 / 944 turbo / 944 S, Model 87, Sheet 5*. The Pi substitutes for the **Heating and A/C control switch**, so almost everything below lands on that unit's A and B connectors.

GERMAN COLOUR ABBREVIATIONS

ABBR	GERMAN	COLOUR	ABBR	GERMAN	COLOUR
SW	schwarz	black	BR	braun	brown (ground)
WS	weiß	white	GR	grau	grey
RT	rot	red	BL	blau	blue
GN	grün	green	GE	gelb	yellow
LI	lila	lilac / violet	RS	rosa	pink

1,0 SW/RT reads as 1.0 mm² black with a red tracer — base colour first, stripe after the slash, cross-section in front.

FLAP ACTUATORS – THE BULK OF THE WORK

Each flap is one DC motor plus one feedback potentiometer in a single 5-pin connector.
Pins 4 and 5 are the motor; 1, 2 and 3 are the pot, with pin 3 as the wiper. Handily, the wiper is the only un-striped wire in each family.

FLAP / PI PINS	PIN	ROLE	WIRE	TERMINAL
Defrost GPIO 16 / 20 ADS A1	4	motor	1,0 GN/SW	B11
	5	motor	1,0 WS/SW	B12
	2	pot end	0,5 SW/BL	B5
	3	wiper	0,5 SW	B7
	1	pot end	0,5 SW/RT	A6
Footwell GPIO 12 / 21 ADS A2	4	motor	1,0 GN/LI	B9
	5	motor	1,0 GN/WS	B10
	2	pot end	0,5 GN/BL	B3
	3	wiper	0,5 GN	B8
	1	pot end	0,5 GN/RT	A5
Blend / temp mix GPIO 23 / 24 ADS A0	4	motor	1,0 GR/SW	A10
	5	motor	1,0 GR/GN	A11
	2	pot end	0,5 GR/RT	A7
	3	wiper	0,5 GR	A12
	1	pot end	0,5 GR/BL	B6

Pot excitation is now your job. The factory control head fed these dividers; the Pi must. Your scaling constants — 225 mV at 0%, 4090 mV at 100% — imply roughly 5 V across the element, so the ADS1115 needs to be on 5 V too. On 3.3 V the top of travel clips and every reading above ~80% is wrong.

On the blend flap the /RT and /BL ends read swapped relative to the other two. That may be deliberate (flap sense) or my reading of the scan — ohm it out before trusting the direction.

SOLENOIDS AND A/C

FUNCTION	PI	WIRE	TERMINAL
Heat valve solenoid	GPIO 19	1,0 SW	A4
Recirc / fresh-air solenoid	GPIO 26	1,0 SW/GN	A3
Solenoid common ground	—	0,5 BR	chassis
A/C clutch request → MS3	GPIO 18	via A/C relay G17	sheet col. A–B

BLOWER – READ THIS BEFORE WIRING RELAYS

The factory blower is **four speeds**, not two. A resistor pack (0.25 / 0.4 / 1.0 / 2.5 Ω in series) is tapped by the fresh-air blower switch:

SWITCH POS.	TAP	WIRE	TERMINAL	RESULT
1	4	1,5 BR/WS	C1	slowest — full resistance
2	3	1,5 WS/GE	C6	—
3	2	2,5 WS	C3	—
4	1	2,5 BR/SW	C5	fastest — least resistance
—	motor	2,5 BR	ground	blower return

Your software models two speeds, the car has four. fan_speed is OFF / LOW / HI driving GPIO 5 and GPIO 6, but the harness offers four taps. Pick two and accept the coarser control, or add two more relays and widen fan_speed — either is fine, but decide before wiring rather than discovering it at the bench.

These are the fat wires on the sheet — 2.5 mm² carrying blower current. Size the relay contacts for the motor's stall draw, not its running draw.

WHAT YOU DO *NOT* NEED TO CONNECT

FACTORY ITEM	WHY IT IS REDUNDANT
Inside / outside / mixed-chamber temp sensors	Replaced by your three DS18B20s on GPIO 4

FACTORY ITEM	WHY IT IS REDUNDANT
Heating and A/C control switch	The Pi <i>is</i> this unit now — you are wiring into its connectors
Fresh air blower switch	Replaced by relays under Pi control
Seat heater time relay and 4-way switches	Bypassed — the Pi drives the elements through MOSFETs on GPIO 13 / 25
Evaporator icing protection	Series safety in the A/C circuit — leave it in place, do not bypass

Before applying power on the bench. Ohm every pot end-to-end (expect a few k Ω) and wiper-to-end (should sweep smoothly as the flap moves by hand). A pot wired where a motor belongs will be destroyed the instant an H-bridge drives it.

Colours here are transcribed from a scan. Buzz each one out at the connector before you commit — the sheet is the map, the meter is the territory.